

Color Adjustments

Learning Objectives

- Adjust brightness, contrast, and color balance
- Use hue-saturation to modify colors
- Correct common photo problems like underexposure

Engage (5-7 minutes)

Have you seen a photo taken at sunset where everything looks orange? Or a dark photo where you cannot see faces clearly? Color adjustments fix these problems—like adjusting the brightness of a bulb or the tint of a window. Today we learn to make every photo look its best.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Open a dark or blurry photo in GIMP. Go to Colors > Brightness-Contrast and increase brightness. Then try Colors > Hue-Saturation to make colors more vibrant. Finally, try Colors > Color Balance to warm up or cool down the image. Save before and after versions to compare.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Brightness controls how light or dark an image is. Contrast adjusts the difference between light and dark areas. Hue-Saturation changes the color intensity and shade. Color Balance shifts the mix of red, green, and blue tones. These adjustments help fix photos that are too dark, too bright, or have unwanted color casts.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Think of adjusting the lights in your house. Too bright and you cannot see the screen; too dark and you cannot read. Photo adjustment is like finding that perfect lighting. If a photo from a school function came out too yellow due to indoor lights, which adjustment would fix it?

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Exit ticket: Name two color adjustment tools and describe what each does. Then adjust a photo's brightness and contrast. If you finish early, try correcting a color cast using Color Balance.